

Olympiad Test Paper — Sanskrit (Class 7) — Paper 3

Chapter 6: क्रीडाम वयं श्लोकान्त्याक्षरीम् (Let Us Play Shloka-Antyakshari)

Paper 3 — (progressively harder)

Subject	Sanskrit (NCERT Class 7, Deepakam)
Chapter	6 — क्रीडाम वयं श्लोकान्त्याक्षरीम् (Let Us Play Shloka-Antyakshari)
Total Questions	60 (Multiple Choice, single correct)
Maximum Marks	240
Suggested Time	90 minutes

Marking scheme: +4 for each correct answer · -1 for each wrong answer · 0 if unattempted.

Instructions: Each question has four options (A), (B), (C), (D); exactly one is correct. Classic P3 traps: तादर्थ्ये चतुर्थी (the -आय endings विवादाय/दानाय are DATIVE 'for the sake of', not genitive/locative); साधोः + विपरीतम् → साधोर्विपरीतम् is VISARGA sandhi (ः→र् before a voiced sound), not a typo; निर्गन्ध = निः+गन्ध (visarga→र्), and the किंशुक is bright-but-SCENTLESS; the wicked-vs-good verse pairs विवाद/मद/परिपीडन (knowledge/wealth/power) AGAINST ज्ञान-sharing/दान/रक्षण — keep the three aligned and do NOT swap the order; खल (moral fault) ≠ मूर्ख (intellectual fault); विद्या (formal learning) ≠ ज्ञान (deep insight); worth rests on शीलम् (= वृत्तम्/आचरणम्), so the शीलम्-less are भारभूताः (= भारकराः, burdens). Do not write on this paper — mark answers on your answer sheet.

1. श्लोकान्त्याक्षरी is best resolved into its parts as:

- (A) श्लोक + अन्त + क्षरी → 'a verse that ends'
- (B) श्लोका + न्त्य + अक्षरी → 'the first syllable of a verse'
- (C) श्लोक + अन्त्य + अक्षर + (feminine -ई) → 'the [game of the] last letter of a verse'
- (D) श्लोक + अन्त्य + क्षीरी → 'the milk of a verse'

2. In श्लोकान्त्याक्षरी the junction श्लोक + अन्त्य yields श्लोकान्त्य. The sandhi at work is:

- (A) अ + अ → ए (guṇa sandhi)
- (B) visarga sandhi (ः → र्)
- (C) consonant doubling before a vowel
- (D) अ + अ → आ (a savarṇa-dīrgha / vowel-lengthening sandhi)

3. The terminal -ई in श्लोकान्त्याक्षरी does the same grammatical work as the -ई in which word?

- (A) गच्छति — it marks the present tense
(B) नदी / यशस्विनी — it marks a feminine noun-form
(C) रामाय — it marks the dative case (D) अगच्छत् — it marks the past tense

4. Grammatically, the compound विद्याहीन ('lacking knowledge') is most precisely analysed as:

- (A) विद्या च हीनः च — a द्वन्द्व compound listing two things
(B) विद्यायाः अधिकः — a compound meaning 'more than knowledge'
(C) हीना विद्या — meaning 'low-grade knowledge'
(D) विद्यया हीनः — a तत्पुरुष compound (the second member 'devoid of' governs the first)

5. Read the line literally: विद्याहीनाः न शोभन्ते. The subject विद्याहीनाः is in which number and case?

- (A) Nominative singular — 'one without knowledge'
(B) Genitive plural — 'of those without knowledge'
(C) Accusative plural — 'the ones without knowledge (object)'
(D) Nominative plural (प्रथमा बहुवचन) — 'those-without-knowledge [people]'

6. The verb form शोभन्ते (from √शुभ्, 'to shine/look beautiful') is:

- (A) third person singular, present — 'he/she shines'
(B) third person plural, past — 'they shone'
(C) third person plural, present tense — 'they shine'
(D) second person plural — 'you all shine'

7. Apply the किंशुक simile to a NEW phrase: निर्गन्धम् पुष्पम्. Reading it the way the verse reads किंशुक, it means a flower that is:

- (A) colour-less but fragrant (B) both colour-less and scent-less
(C) scent-less (it may still be coloured, but has no fragrance)
(D) freshly bloomed and fragrant

8. निर्गन्ध is formed from निः + गन्ध. The change निः → निर् before गन्ध is an instance of:

- (A) vowel lengthening (अ + अ → आ) (B) guṇa sandhi (अ + इ → ए)
(C) visarga sandhi — ः becomes र् before a voiced consonant
(D) anusvāra replacing a nasal

9. The simile likens विद्याहीनाः to किंशुकाः. The grammatical role of इव in 'किंशुकाः इव' is to:

- (A) negate किंशुकाः ('not the किंशुक')
(B) mark a comparison ('like / just as'), making किंशुकाः the standard of comparison
(C) make किंशुकाः the direct object of an action (D) turn किंशुकाः into a question

10. Why is translating किंशुक merely as 'a beautiful flower' a SUBSTANTIVE error in this simile (not just a vague one)?

- (A) It exaggerates the flower's rarity (B) It changes the flower's colour in the simile
 (C) It deletes the scent-less detail, on which the whole 'beauty without inner worth' analogy depends
 (D) It makes the flower the subject instead of the object

11. Identify the specific tree the किंशुक names, and the single botanical feature the verse exploits:

- (A) the Flame of the Forest (Butea monosperma); its blazing colour combined with absence of fragrance
 (B) the lotus; its growth in water yet purity (C) the rose; its fragrance yet thorns
 (D) the mango; its sweetness yet sourness when raw

12. Re-state the lesson of विद्याहीना न शोभन्ते as a conditional. Which is faithful?

- (A) If a person has beauty, then विद्या becomes unnecessary.
 (B) If a person lacks beauty, then विद्या cannot help.
 (C) If a person has विद्या, then beauty is guaranteed.
 (D) If a person lacks विद्या, then outward beauty alone cannot make that person truly shine.

13. In the verse विद्या विवादाय ... the form विवादाय is in which case, and why?

- (A) Dative (चतुर्थी), expressing purpose — 'for [the sake of] quarrel' (तादर्थ्ये चतुर्थी)
 (B) Genitive (षष्ठी) — 'of quarrel' (C) Locative (सप्तमी) — 'in quarrel'
 (D) Ablative (पञ्चमी) — 'from quarrel'

14. Across the wicked half of the verse, विवादाय, मदाय and परिपीडनाय all share which grammatical feature?

- (A) All three are dative (चतुर्थी) forms expressing purpose
 (B) All three are genitive forms expressing possession
 (C) All three are nominative subjects of the sentence
 (D) All three are vocatives addressing a person

15. Match each gift to the harm it becomes in the wicked, KEEPING the verse's order विद्या—धन—शक्ति:

- (A) विद्या→मद, धन→परिपीडन, शक्ति→विवाद (B) विद्या→परिपीडन, धन→विवाद, शक्ति→मद
 (C) विद्या→विवाद (quarrel), धन→मद (pride), शक्ति→परिपीडन (oppression)
 (D) विद्या→मद, धन→विवाद, शक्ति→परिपीडन

16. मद, the wicked outcome of धन, is best rendered as:

- (A) intoxicating pride / arrogance (B) generous giving
 (C) quarrelsome dispute (D) physical oppression

17. परिपीडनाय (शक्तिः परेषाम् परिपीडनाय) means the wicked use power to:

- (A) protect others (B) oppress themselves only
 (C) oppress / torment OTHERS (परेषाम् = of others)

(D) share power with others

18. A ruler levies crushing taxes purely to humiliate rivals. In the verse's vocabulary this is शक्ति turned to:

- (A) रक्षण (protection) (B) दान (giving)
(C) परिपीडन (oppression of others) (D) मद (pride)

19. In the good half, knowledge serves ज्ञानाय / sharing of learning. The form ज्ञानाय parallels विवादाय in being:

- (A) a genitive of possession — 'of knowledge'
(B) a dative of purpose — 'for [the spread of] knowledge'
(C) a nominative subject — 'knowledge shines'(D) an instrumental — 'by knowledge'

20. Match each gift to its GOOD use, keeping the order विद्या-धन-शक्ति:

- (A) विद्या→sharing of learning (ज्ञान), धन→दान (giving), शक्ति→रक्षण (protection)
(B) विद्या→दान, धन→रक्षण, शक्ति→sharing of learning
(C) विद्या→रक्षण, धन→sharing of learning, शक्ति→दान
(D) विद्या→दान, धन→sharing of learning, शक्ति→रक्षण

21. दान, the good use of धन, is the exact moral opposite of which wicked outcome?

- (A) विवाद (quarrel) — the wicked use of knowledge
(B) परिपीडन (oppression) — the wicked use of power
(C) रक्षण (protection) — the good use of power
(D) मद (the hoarder's pride) — both stem from wealth, but दान gives away while मद clutches

22. A wealthy merchant funds a free hospital. Mapped onto the verse, his धन is being used for:

- (A) दान (giving) — the good use of wealth(B) मद (pride) — the wicked use of wealth
(C) रक्षण (protection) — the good use of power
(D) विवाद (quarrel) — the wicked use of knowledge

23. Why is it a logical error to say 'the good and the wicked both use विद्या for विवाद'?

- (A) Because the good never possess विद्या at all
(B) The verse is built on OPPOSITE uses; the good share knowledge (ज्ञानाय) while only the wicked turn it to विवाद
(C) Because विद्या is used the same way by everyone
(D) Because विवाद is actually the GOOD use of knowledge

24. Identify the case of शक्ति: in 'शक्तिः परेषाम् परिपीडनाय':

- (A) Nominative (प्रथमा) — शक्तिः is the subject 'power [serves...]'
(B) Genitive (षष्ठी) — 'of power' (C) Dative (चतुर्थी) — 'for power'
(D) Instrumental (तृतीया) — 'by power'

- 25.** परेषाम् in the verse is the genitive plural of पर. It modifies परिपीडन to mean:
(A) 'oppression by others' (B) 'self-oppression'
(C) 'oppression OF OTHERS' (others = those who are 'beyond/other')
(D) 'oppression for one friend'
- 26.** The contrast-clause खलस्य साधोर्विपरीतम्. The two genitives खलस्य and साधोः mean:
(A) 'to the wicked' and 'to the good' (dative)
(B) 'of the wicked' and 'of the good' — marking whose use is described
(C) 'from the wicked' and 'from the good' (ablative)
(D) 'O wicked!' and 'O good one!' (vocative)
- 27.** In writing, the phrase is seen as साधोर्विपरीतम्. The र् in साधोर् results from:
(A) a printing slip; it should be साधोःविपरीतम् (B) vowel sandhi (ओ + व → ?)
(C) doubling of व for emphasis
(D) visarga sandhi — साधोः + विपरीतम् → साधोर्विपरीतम् (ः → र् before voiced व)
- 28.** विपरीतम् (in साधोर्विपरीतम्) is split as वि + परीत. The prefix वि- here adds the sense of:
(A) intensity — 'very much so' (B) togetherness — 'along with'
(C) downward motion — 'falling'
(D) reversal / opposition — 'turned the opposite way'
- 29.** The single word that carries the whole moral pivot of the wicked-vs-good verse is:
(A) किंशुक — naming the flower (B) शोभन्ते — 'they shine'
(C) विपरीतम् ('opposite') — it flips every gift's use between खल and साधु
(D) अक्षर — 'syllable'
- 30.** If the verse had read खलस्य साधोश्च समानम् instead of विपरीतम्, its teaching would become:
(A) stronger — it would intensify the contrast
(B) false — it would wrongly claim the wicked and good use gifts the SAME way
(C) unchanged — समान and विपरीत mean the same
(D) about flowers instead of people
- 31.** The defining difference between खलः and मूर्खः is best captured as:
(A) खल = intellectual failing; मूर्ख = moral failing (B) both are moral failings of equal kind
(C) both are merely intellectual failings
(D) खल = a MORAL failing (ill-willed by choice); मूर्ख = an INTELLECTUAL failing (merely unwise)
- 32.** Which person is a खलः rather than a मूर्खः?
(A) A kind farmer who cannot read or do sums
(B) A child who gives a wrong answer by mistake
(C) An elder who forgets names easily
(D) A clever lawyer who uses his learning to deliberately ruin innocent people

33. Which person is a मूर्खः, NOT a खलः?

- (A) A minister who twists the law to jail his rivals
- (B) A trader who cheats every customer knowingly
- (C) A scholar who spreads lies to spark riots
- (D) A well-meaning man who keeps giving bad advice because he never learned the subject

34. Why does the wicked-vs-good verse target the खल specifically, and not the मूर्ख?

- (A) Because the verse is about the deliberate MISUSE of gifts, which is a fault of will (khal), not of mere ignorance (mūrkhā)
- (B) Because the मूर्ख has no gifts to misuse
- (C) Because खल and मूर्ख are the same and either word fits
- (D) Because the मूर्ख is actually the good person of the verse

35. A scholar memorises whole texts yet uses them only to win arguments and shame others. The chapter would call him a:

- (A) खलः — learned, but morally corrupt in his use of learning
- (B) मूर्खः — because real scholars are never foolish
- (C) साधुः — because he is learned
- (D) किंशुकः — a fragrant flower

36. भारभूताः is split as भार + भूत. The participle भूत here means:

- (A) 'ghost / spirit'
- (B) 'the earth'
- (C) 'become / having become' — so the whole = 'those who have become a burden'
- (D) 'truth'

37. The text glosses भारभूताः with भारकराः. The element -कर in भारकर means:

- (A) 'hand'
- (B) 'tax'
- (C) 'making / causing' — so भारकर = 'burden-making (those who cause a burden)'
- (D) 'ray of light'

38. By the chapter's standard, WHO is the भारभूतः — the burden on the earth?

- (A) The person devoid of शीलम् (good character), however rich, handsome or high-born
- (B) The person devoid of wealth, however good
- (C) The person devoid of beauty, however learned
- (D) The person of low birth, however virtuous

39. The text glosses शीलम् as वृत्तम् / आचरणम्. Therefore शीलम् is closest in meaning to:

- (A) one's wealth and property
- (B) one's physical beauty
- (C) one's family lineage
- (D) one's conduct / habitual moral behaviour

40. A man is wealthy (धनवान्), handsome (रूपवान्) and high-born (कुलीन) but cruel and dishonest. The chapter judges him:

- (A) fully worthy, since he has wealth, looks and birth
- (B) a भारभूतः — a burden, because he lacks शीलम्, the one thing that confers worth

- (C) a साधुः, because of his noble family
(D) a किंशुक, because he is handsome and fragrant

41. Put the chapter's value-hierarchy in the right order (highest worth first):

- (A) शीलम् (character) and विद्या (knowledge) above रूपम् (beauty), लक्ष्मीः (wealth) and कुलम् (birth)
(B) लक्ष्मीः and रूपम् above शीलम् and विद्या (C) कुलम् alone above everything else
(D) रूपम् above all, since the verse praises the किंशुक's colour

42. Two students share the same wealth and good looks; one is honest and helpful, the other deceitful. The chapter says the difference that decides their worth is:

- (A) धनम् (wealth) — but it is equal, so it decides
(B) शीलम् (character) — the honest one has it, the deceitful one lacks it
(C) रूपम् (beauty) — but it is equal, so it decides (D) कुलम् (birth) — assumed to differ

43. The chapter distinguishes विद्या from ज्ञान. The sharper statement of the difference is:

- (A) विद्या is deep insight; ज्ञान is mere schoolwork (B) both mean exactly the same thing
(C) विद्या is formal, acquired learning (what is studied); ज्ञान is direct, realised insight (what is deeply known)
(D) विद्या means wealth; ज्ञान means character

44. विद्यालय literally combines विद्या + आलय. The sandhi and meaning are:

- (A) अ + आ → ए, giving 'wise person' (B) no sandhi; it means 'a learned book'
(C) इ + आ → या, giving 'a question'
(D) अ + आ → आ, giving 'abode of learning' = a school

45. ज्ञानी and विद्यालय show how the two roots build words. Correctly:

- (A) ज्ञानी = 'place of knowing', विद्यालय = 'a wise person'
(B) ज्ञानी = 'a knowing/wise person' (agent), विद्यालय = 'place of learning' (location)
(C) both name persons (D) both name places

46. 'A great ज्ञानी may have little formal विद्या, and a person of much विद्या may lack ज्ञान.' This statement is:

- (A) self-contradictory — the two words mean the same
(B) coherent — because विद्या (studied learning) and ज्ञान (realised insight) are distinct, one can exist without the other
(C) false — ज्ञान always requires more विद्या
(D) false — विद्या always produces ज्ञान automatically

47. लक्ष्मीः in the chapter denotes wealth/fortune personified. Its grammatical gender is:

- (A) masculine
(B) feminine (it is a goddess-name, declined as a feminine noun)
(C) neuter (D) it has no gender

48. यशस्विनी and यशस्वी differ in that:

- (A) यशस्विनी means 'without fame', यशस्वी means 'with fame'
- (B) they belong to different roots, one fame and one wealth
- (C) यशस्विनी is the feminine form ('a famous woman'), यशस्वी the masculine ('a famous man') — both built on यशस् (fame)
- (D) यशस्विनी is plural, यशस्वी singular

49. From यशस् ('fame') we get यशस्वी ('famous'). By the same pattern, a word for 'one possessing tejas (lustre)' would be:

- (A) तेजस्वी
- (B) अतेजस् ('lustre-less')
- (C) तेजःहीन ('without lustre')
- (D) तेजाय ('for lustre')

50. Synthesis: the किंशुक verse and the शीलम् verse together argue that:

- (A) outward splendour is the highest good
- (B) outward splendour (colour, looks, wealth) without an inner good (knowledge, character) is empty — like colour without scent
- (C) knowledge and character are unimportant if one is beautiful
- (D) the किंशुक verse praises wealth and the शीलम् verse praises beauty

51. A single principle unifies the whole chapter. Which states it best?

- (A) More gifts always mean more worth
- (B) Outward beauty and wealth are sufficient for a worthy life
- (C) Knowledge alone, even misused, guarantees worth
- (D) The worth of any gift or trait is decided by the INNER quality (knowledge, character) and the USE to which it is put, not by the gift itself

52. Spot the FALSE statement about the chapter:

- (A) 'In the wicked, knowledge serves quarrel.'
- (B) 'शीलम् is glossed as वृत्तम्/आचरणम्.'
- (C) 'विपरीतम् marks the opposite uses of the good and the wicked.'
- (D) 'The किंशुक is praised as a model because its fragrance proves inner worth.'

53. Which chain of reasoning is fully consistent with the chapter?

- (A) He has विद्या → therefore he shines → therefore he must be a साधु
- (B) He is wealthy and handsome → therefore he has शीलम् → therefore he is worthy
- (C) He is scentless like a किंशुक → therefore he is wise
- (D) He has विद्या but uses it to start quarrels → his use is विवाद → he acts as a खल → his real worth is low because he lacks शीलम्

54. A debater claims: 'Since दान and मद both come from धन, the verse treats them as the same.' The correct rebuttal is:

- (A) They are indeed the same, as both involve money
- (B) They share the SOURCE (धन) but are OPPOSITE outcomes — दान is the good's giving, मद the wicked's pride; same gift, विपरीत use

- (C) दान and मद come from different gifts, not from धन
(D) Neither दान nor मद has anything to do with धन

55. Final synthesis: the truest one-line statement of what makes a person worthy, per the chapter, is:

- (A) विद्या (knowledge well used) together with शीलम् (good character) — not रूप, लक्ष्मी or कुल
(B) लक्ष्मी (wealth) and रूप (beauty) above all
(C) कुल (high birth) alone
(D) यशस् (fame) by itself, however gained

56. In श्लोकान्त्याक्षरी, if a player ends a verse on the syllable 'क' (ka), the next player must begin a verse with:

- (A) a verse whose first syllable is the FIRST letter of the previous verse
(B) any verse at all, freely chosen
(C) a verse whose first syllable is 'क' (ka) — the LAST letter just heard
(D) a verse whose LAST syllable is also 'क'

57. A player wants to continue after a verse ending in '...शोभन्ते'. Which opening syllable must the next verse have?

- (A) ते (te) — the actual final syllable of शोभन्ते
(B) शो (śo) — the first syllable of शोभन्ते
(C) भ (bha) — a middle syllable
(D) न (na) — a middle syllable

58. Consider the new phrase धनम् दानाय. Following the verse's grammar, it means:

- (A) 'wealth [is] for giving' — दानाय is a dative of purpose, just like the verse's विवादाय/मदाय
(B) 'wealth of the gift' — दानाय as a genitive
(C) 'giving away the wealth' — दानाय as an object
(D) 'wealth in the gift' — दानाय as a locative

59. Why can a person be a विद्वान् (learned) and yet, by the chapter's measure, be worthless?

- (A) Because a learned person can never be worthless
(B) Because learning (विद्या) without शीलम् (character), or learning misused as विवाद, leaves a person a भारभूतः despite knowledge
(C) Because learning automatically destroys character
(D) Because only wealth, not learning, gives worth

60. Compare two givers: the साधु gives wealth as दान, while the खल flaunts wealth as मद. The deepest difference the verse points to is:

- (A) the AMOUNT of wealth each holds
(B) the INTENT and direction of use — outward for others (दान) versus inward self-glorification (मद)
(C) the SOURCE from which the wealth came
(D) the COLOUR of the wealth, as with the किंशुक

Solutions — Sanskrit (Class 7), Chapter 6: क्रीडाम वयं श्लोकान्त्याक्षरीम् (Let Us Play Shloka-Antyakshari) — Paper 3

Paper 3 — (progressively harder)

Marking: +4 correct, -1 wrong, 0 unattempted. Maximum marks **240**.

Answer Key

Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans	Q	Ans
1	C	11	A	21	D	31	D	41	A	51	D
2	D	12	D	22	A	32	D	42	B	52	D
3	B	13	A	23	B	33	D	43	C	53	D
4	D	14	A	24	A	34	A	44	D	54	B
5	D	15	C	25	C	35	A	45	B	55	A
6	C	16	A	26	B	36	C	46	B	56	C
7	C	17	C	27	D	37	C	47	B	57	A
8	C	18	C	28	D	38	A	48	C	58	A
9	B	19	B	29	C	39	D	49	A	59	B
10	C	20	A	30	B	40	B	50	B	60	B

Answer-key distribution: A = 15, B = 15, C = 15, D = 15.

Worked Solutions

1. (C) The word is श्लोक ('verse') + अन्त्य ('last') + अक्षर ('letter/syllable'), capped by a feminine -ई that names the game. The split श्लोक+अन्त+क्षरी invents a non-word क्षरी and ignores अक्षर; श्लोका+न्त्य+अक्षरी mis-segments and reverses the sense to 'first'; श्लोक+अन्त्य+क्षीरी drags in क्षीर ('milk'), unrelated to the syllable अक्षर.

2. (D) श्लोक ends in अ and अन्त्य begins with अ; अ + अ combine to the long आ (दीर्घ सन्धि), giving श्लोकाऽन्त्य. अ + अ never gives ए — गुण (ए) arises from अ + इ. No visarga is present, and nothing is doubled here.

3. (B) The -ई of श्लोकान्त्याक्षरी forms a feminine substantive (the game's name), exactly as the feminine -ई appears in नदी or यशस्विनी. The -ति of गच्छति is a verbal (present-tense) ending, -आय in रामाय is a dative ending, and the augment-plus-ending of अगच्छत् marks past tense — none of these is the feminine -ई.

4. (D) विद्याहीन unpacks as विद्या हीनः, 'devoid of (by means of) knowledge' — a तत्पुरुष where हीन ('bereft') takes विद्या as its complement. A द्वन्द्व would list two coordinate items ('knowledge and the deprived'), which is nonsense here; 'more than knowledge' reverses the sense of हीन; and 'low-grade knowledge' makes विद्या the head, but the head is the deprived person, not the knowledge.

5. (D) विद्याहीनाः ends in -आः, the masculine nominative PLURAL, and it agrees with the plural verb शोभन्ते ('they shine'). A singular would be विद्याहीनः with शोभते; the genitive plural is विद्याहीनानाम्; the accusative plural is विद्याहीनान्. The -आः subject form plus a plural verb fixes it as nominative plural.

6. (C) शोभन्ते is the ātmanepada third-person PLURAL present of √शुभ् — 'they shine'. The singular would be शोभते; a past sense would need the augment अ- (e.g. अशोभन्त); and the second-person plural would be शोभध्वे. The -न्ते ending is the marker of third-person plural here.

7. (C) निर्गन्ध = निः ('without') + गन्ध ('scent'), so निर्गन्धम् पुष्पम् is a 'scent-less flower' — it says nothing against colour, exactly as the verse praises the किंशुक's colour while denying it fragrance. 'Colour-less' would need निर्वर्ण/अवर्ण, not निर्गन्ध; 'both' over-reads the single prefix निः; and 'fragrant' is the very opposite of निर्गन्ध.

8. (C) The visarga of निः changes to र् because the following sound गँ (the voiced ग) triggers ः → र् — standard visarga sandhi, giving निर्गन्ध. It is not vowel lengthening (no अ+अ here), not guṇa (no इ/उ following), and no anusvāra is involved.

9. (B) इव is the particle of comparison, 'like/as', so 'किंशुकाः इव' = 'like किंशुका flowers' — the unlearned are compared to bright-but-scentless blossoms. इव does not negate (that is न/अ-), does not assign object-hood (it is not a verb's complement), and does not form a question (that would be किम्/अपि).

10. (C) The simile's force lies in a flower that is gorgeously coloured yet has NO fragrance — mirroring beauty/wealth with no knowledge. Saying just 'beautiful flower' keeps the colour but silently drops the scent-less point, collapsing the analogy. It is not about rarity, the colour is retained, and the grammatical subject is unaffected — the loss is specifically the निर्गन्ध detail.

11. (A) किंशुक is the Flame of the Forest (Butea monosperma), chosen because its flowers are brilliantly coloured but scentless — the exact mismatch the verse needs. The lotus (पद्म), rose (and its fragrance), and mango all carry fragrance or different traits, so none supplies the 'colour without scent' contrast.

12. (D) The verse's logic is: absence of knowledge ⇒ no true 'shine', even with looks. 'Beauty makes विद्या unnecessary' inverts the moral; 'lacking beauty defeats विद्या' is never claimed; and 'विद्या guarantees beauty' confuses inner worth with physical looks. Only the first conditional preserves 'knowledge, not looks, gives worth.'

13. (A) विवादाय ends in -आय, the dative singular, and here it expresses purpose ('knowledge [serves] FOR quarrel') — the तादर्थ्ये चतुर्थी use. The genitive would be विवादस्य ('of'), the locative विवादे ('in'), and the ablative विवादात् ('from') — none of which gives the 'for the sake of' purpose the verse intends.

14. (A) विवादाय, मदाय, परिपीडनाय each end in -आय — the dative/चतुर्थी expressing the purpose to which विद्या, धन and शक्ति are turned in the wicked. They are not genitives (which would end -स्य), not nominative subjects (the subjects are विद्या/धनम्/शक्तिः), and not vocatives (no address is being made).

15. (C) The verse aligns each in order: knowledge → quarrel (विवाद), wealth → pride (मद), power → oppression (परिपीडन). Each distractor rotates or swaps the mapping — e.g. attaching मद (pride, a wealth-disease) to विद्या, or परिपीडन (oppression, a power-abuse) to धन — breaking the one-to-one alignment the shloka fixes.

16. (A) मद is the 'intoxication' of arrogance that wealth breeds in the wicked. Generous giving is दान (the GOOD use of wealth), quarrel is विवाद (the wicked use of knowledge), and oppression is परिपीडन (the wicked use of power) — each belongs to a different gift, so मद alone fits धन's misuse.

17. (C) परेषाम् is the genitive plural 'of others', and परिपीडनाय is 'for tormenting' — so the wicked turn power to the oppression of OTHERS. Protection is रक्षण (the good use); 'themselves only' ignores परेषाम् ('others'); and 'sharing' is the opposite of पीडन ('tormenting').

18. (C) Using power to crush and humiliate others is precisely परिपीडन, the wicked use of शक्ति. रक्षण (protection) is its GOOD use; दान (giving) belongs to wealth; मद (pride) belongs to wealth's misuse — only परिपीडन matches an abuse of power against others.

19. (B) Just as विवादaya is 'for quarrel', ज्ञानाय is 'for knowledge[-sharing]' — both -आय datives of purpose, mirroring each other across the wicked/good split. The genitive would be ज्ञानस्य, the nominative ज्ञानम्, and the instrumental ज्ञानेन — none expresses the purpose the contrast requires.

20. (A) In the good, knowledge is shared (ज्ञान), wealth is given (दान), power protects (रक्षण), each in the same order as the gifts. The distractors shuffle these — e.g. assigning दान (a wealth-virtue) to विद्या or रक्षण (a power-virtue) to धन — breaking the verse's parallel one-to-one mapping.

21. (D) Both दान and मद spring from धन (wealth): the good give it (दान), the wicked swell with pride over it (मद) — they are the same gift's opposite outcomes. विवाद and परिपीडन are misuses of knowledge and power, not wealth; रक्षण is a power-virtue. Only मद is wealth's wicked twin to दान.

22. (A) Funding a free hospital is generous giving — दान, wealth's good use. मद would be flaunting riches arrogantly; रक्षण is what power (not wealth) does well; विवाद is knowledge misused. The act is wealth deployed for others' benefit, which the verse names दान.

23. (B) खलस्य साधोर्विपरीतम् — wicked and good use the SAME gifts oppositely; the good spread knowledge, the wicked quarrel with it. The claim flattens that contrast. The good DO possess विद्या (they just use it well); the uses are opposite, not identical; and विवाद is the WICKED, not the good, use.

24. (A) शक्तिः ends in the visarga of the feminine nominative singular and is the subject of the clause ('power [is] for oppressing others'). The genitive would be शक्तेः, the dative शक्त्यै, the instrumental शक्त्या — but here power is the doer/subject, hence nominative.

25. (C) परेषाम् is षष्ठी बहुवचन ('of others'), so परेषाम् परिपीडनाय = 'for the oppression OF others'. 'By others' would need an instrumental (परैः); 'self-oppression' contradicts पर ('other'); and 'one friend' is wrong in both number (plural) and sense (पर means 'other', not 'friend').

26. (B) खलस्य (-स्य) and साधोः (-ओः) are genitives: 'of the wicked / of the good', i.e. these are their respective uses. Datives would be खलाय/साधवे, ablatives खलात्/साधोः-different sense, vocatives खल/साधो. The षष्ठी here links the gifts to their possessor-users.

27. (D) साधोः ends in visarga; before the voiced व the visarga regularly becomes र, giving साधोर्विपरीतम् — correct sandhi, not a misprint. It is not a vowel sandhi (the ओ is untouched) and व is not doubled. Knowing this prevents 'correcting' a proper form back to साधोःविपरीतम्.

28. (D) वि- on परीत yields 'reversed, opposite' (वि- as विरोध/विपर्यय), capturing that the good's use is the reverse of the wicked's. वि- can mean 'apart/away', but the resulting word here means 'opposite', not 'very', not 'with' (that is सम्/सह), nor 'falling down' (that is नि-/अव-).

29. (C) विपरीतम् is the hinge: it announces that for the good, every use is the REVERSE of the wicked's. किंशुक belongs to the different विद्याहीन verse, शोभन्ते is its verb, and अक्षर belongs to the game-name — none of those pivots the wicked/good contrast as विपरीतम् does.

30. (B) समानम् means 'the same', the exact opposite of विपरीतम् ('opposite'); swapping it would destroy the verse's truth by claiming khal and sādhu behave identically. It does not intensify the contrast (it erases it), समान and विपरीत are antonyms (not synonyms), and the subject stays people, not flowers.

31. (D) A खल misuses gifts on purpose — a flaw of CHARACTER (moral); a मूर्ख simply lacks wisdom — a flaw of INTELLECT, without malice. The reversal misattributes malice to the fool; and collapsing both into one category ignores that one is willed wickedness and the other innocent folly.

32. (D) The lawyer turns विद्या to harm BY CHOICE — malicious intent, the mark of the खल. The unlettered-but-kind farmer, the mistaken child, and the forgetful elder all lack

knowledge or sharpness without ill will — that is मूर्ख / mere limitation, not wickedness.

33. (D) Bad advice from honest ignorance is folly without malice — मूर्ख. The minister twisting law, the knowing cheat, and the scholar inciting riots all act with deliberate ill-intent — that is the moral fault of the खल, not the innocent unwisdom of the मूर्ख.

34. (A) Turning विद्या/धन/शक्ति to quarrel/pride/oppression is a CHOICE — the moral defect of the खल. A मूर्ख errs from ignorance, not malicious choice, so the contrast needs the खल. A मूर्ख may still hold gifts; the two words are not interchangeable; and the मूर्ख is certainly not the साधु.

35. (A) He has विद्या but bends it to विवाद and shaming — willed misuse, the खल. He is not मूर्ख (he is plainly learned), not साधु (the good would SHARE learning), and 'किंशुक' is a flower, irrelevant; besides, the किंशुक is scentless, not fragrant.

36. (C) भूत is the past participle of √भू ('to be/become'), so भारभूत = 'become-a-burden'. Though भूत can elsewhere mean 'ghost' or 'creature', here the compound needs 'become'; 'earth' is भूमि/पृथ्वी, and 'truth' is सत्य — neither yields 'those who have become a burden'.

37. (C) Here -कर (from √कृ, 'to do/make') means 'making', so भारकर = 'one who makes a burden', matching भारभूत ('become a burden'). कर can elsewhere mean 'hand', 'tax', or 'ray', but in this gloss it is the agentive 'maker', confirming the burden sense.

38. (A) The chapter pins worth on शीलम्; the character-less person is the true burden, even if rich/handsome/high-born. Lacking wealth, beauty, or high birth does NOT make one a burden — those are precisely the externals the verse refuses to count. Only the absence of CHARACTER does.

39. (D) वृत्त and आचरण both mean 'conduct/behaviour', so शीलम् is moral conduct — how one habitually acts. Wealth is धन/लक्ष्मी, beauty is रूप, lineage is कुल — the very externals the chapter ranks BELOW शीलम्, not equates with it.

40. (B) Three externals cannot offset the absence of शीलम्; without character he is the burden the chapter names. Wealth/looks/birth do NOT secure worth here; noble family alone does not make a साधु (whose mark is good conduct); and the किंशुक comparison would, if anything, condemn him as bright-but-empty — and the किंशुक is scentless, not fragrant.

41. (A) The shlokas exalt inner goods — character and knowledge — over outward looks, wealth and birth. Putting wealth/beauty on top inverts the moral; birth-above-all is exactly what the chapter denies; and the किंशुक's colour is praised only to EXPOSE that mere beauty (no scent / no worth) is empty, not to crown रूपम्.

42. (B) With wealth and looks equal, the ONLY differentiator the chapter values is character — शीलम् — which the honest student has. Equal wealth and equal beauty cannot

be the deciding factor (they cancel out), and birth is neither stated to differ nor counted by the chapter as the source of worth.

43. (C) विद्या is learning gained by study; ज्ञान is the deeper, realised knowing a sage attains. The reversal swaps their senses; they are not identical (the chapter contrasts them); and neither means wealth (धन) or character (शीलम्) — those are separate goods.

44. (D) विद्या (ends in आ) + आलय ('abode') → विद्यालय, 'abode of learning' = school; आ + आ merge to आ (दीर्घ). The output is a place, not a person (a wise person is ज्ञानी/विद्वान्), it is not a book, and the vowels involved are आ + आ, not इ + आ.

45. (B) The -इन् in ज्ञानी makes an agent ('one who has ज्ञान' = wise person), while -आलय in विद्यालय makes a place ('abode of विद्या' = school). Swapping them, or making both persons or both places, ignores that one suffix is agentive and the other locational.

46. (B) Since विद्या and ज्ञान are different (acquired learning vs deep insight), a wise person may have realised much with little schooling, and a heavily-schooled person may lack insight — the statement is coherent. It is not contradictory (the words differ), and neither entails the other automatically.

47. (B) लक्ष्मी is a feminine noun (the personified goddess of fortune), nominative लक्ष्मीः. It is not masculine or neuter, and every Sanskrit substantive carries a gender — so 'no gender' is impossible.

48. (C) Both derive from यशस् ('fame') with the possessive -विन्/-वत् sense; -इनी marks feminine (famous woman), the bare -वी masculine (famous man). Neither is a negation (that needs अ-/नि-), they share ONE root (यशस्), and the difference is gender, not number.

49. (A) The -वी/-विन् possessive that turns यशस् → यशस्वी turns तेजस् → तेजस्वी ('possessing lustre'). अतेजस् and तेजःहीन both NEGATE lustre (the opposite formation), and तेजाय is merely a dative 'for lustre', not a possessive adjective.

50. (B) Both verses subordinate the external to the internal: the scentless-but-bright किंशुक and the character-less-but-rich man are each 'empty splendour'. Praising outward splendour, or dismissing knowledge/character, inverts both verses; and neither verse praises wealth or beauty as the goal — they EXPOSE them.

51. (D) Every shloka turns on use and inner quality: gifts harm in the खल and help in the साधु; beauty without knowledge is empty; worth rests on शीलम्. 'More gifts = more worth' ignores misuse; beauty/wealth are shown insufficient; and even विद्या becomes विवाद when misused — so knowledge alone, misused, does NOT guarantee worth.

52. (D) The किंशुक is SCENTLESS, and it is a warning, not a model — so claiming it has fragrance proving inner worth is doubly false. The other three are accurate: knowledge → quarrel in the wicked, शीलम् = वृत्त/आचरण, and विपरीतम् names the opposite uses.

53. (D) Knowledge misused for quarrel marks the खल, and lacking शीलम् makes worth low — a chain the chapter endorses. Having विद्या does not by itself make a साधु (it can become विवाद); wealth and looks do NOT confer शीलम्; and being 'scentless like किंशुक' signals empty show, the OPPOSITE of wisdom.

54. (B) The verse's whole point (खलस्य साधोर्विपरीतम्) is that ONE gift yields OPPOSITE results in the wicked and the good — so दान and मद, both from धन, are contraries, not the same. They are not 'the same' (one gives, one hoards in pride); both DO arise from धन (so the other two distractors are factually wrong).

55. (A) The chapter repeatedly subordinates beauty (रूप), wealth (लक्ष्मी), birth (कुल) and even fame to the inner goods — knowledge rightly used and character (शीलम्). Crowning wealth/beauty, birth, or unearned fame each contradicts the express teaching that worth is inner, not outer.

56. (C) The game's rule (अन्त्य-अक्षर = 'last letter') is that each new verse STARTS with the LAST syllable of the previous one — here, क. Starting from the previous verse's first letter, choosing freely, or matching the new verse's ENDING all break the last-letter chain that defines the game.

57. (A) श्लोकान्त्याक्षरी keys on the LAST syllable; शोभन्ते ends in ते, so the next verse must begin with ते. शो is the FIRST syllable (used in antyakshari only if you misread the rule), and भ/न are interior syllables — none is the final अक्षर the game demands.

58. (A) दानाय is the -आय dative of purpose ('for giving'), mirroring the verse's pattern विद्या विवादाय / धनं मदाय; so धनम् दानाय = 'wealth is for giving'. A genitive would be दानस्य, an object दानम्, a locative दाने — none expresses the 'for the sake of' purpose the -आय ending carries.

59. (B) The chapter ties worth to character and the right USE of gifts: a learned khal turns विद्या to विवाद, and one without शीलम् is a burden — so learning alone does not secure worth. It is false that the learned are never worthless (the khal is the counterexample); learning does not destroy character; and the chapter does NOT make wealth the source of worth.

60. (B) Same gift (धन), opposite use: the साधु directs it to others as दान, the खल turns it inward as pride (मद) — the verse's विपरीत pivot is about USE and intent, not quantity. The amount and source are never the verse's criterion, and 'colour of wealth' confuses this verse with the किंशुक simile, which is about flowers, not money.